PRE-PURCHASE INSPECTION CHECKLIST

Toyota Land Cruiser FJ45 / FJ55

1960–1984 (FJ45) · 1967–1980 (FJ55) · FJ45 · FJ55

BOXYTRUCKS

CHECK BEFORE YOU BUY

- [ ] **Rust is the deal**
  On an FJ55, Hagerty's checklist starts at the roof near the drip rails, then the cowl, fenders, doors, rocker panels and wheel arches. Under it, check the frame rails, body mounts and anywhere mud collects.
- [ ] **Judge the old repairs**
  Replacement panels generally don't exist for the FJ55, so past rust repairs were fabricated. Look closely at how well they were done, since redoing them is expensive.
- [ ] **Trim and seals**
  Weatherstripping and trim are hard to find. A truck with complete trim is worth more than its paint suggests.
- [ ] **Interior condition**
  Vinyl seats tear and original dash tops and rubber mats go brittle. Original, undamaged interiors are the most desirable.
- [ ] **Test the tailgate window**
  The FJ55's power tailgate window works from a dash switch or the key. Make sure it does, with the tailgate both up and down. A dead window is often a stuck safety switch or a corroded power strip, but it can also be a stripped regulator (see the repair below).
- [ ] **Brakes**
  Stock drums are adequate if they work well and the powertrain is stock. Disc upgrades are common and parts are easy to find; check what's been fitted and how.
- [ ] **Engine health**
  The F and 2F are durable with basic maintenance and periodic valve adjustments. Compression matters more than mileage, and mechanical repairs are cheap next to rust repair.
- [ ] **Know which truck it is**
  Check the wheelbase and engine code against the chassis plate: FJ45 wagons, pickups and diesel HJ/BJ versions differ, and export-spec trucks are sometimes misidentified.

RECALLS TO ASK ABOUT

- [ ] **Wiring campaign (1968–69 Land Cruisers)**
  1968–1969 · NHTSA 69V027000

IS IT THE REAL THING?

- [ ] **FJ55 frame numbers**
  Owners date FJ55s from the frame number using Toyota production microfiche, for example frames 76441–77572 for July 1977. Some California titles carry an extra leading zero that isn't on the frame, so check that the numbers match.

- [ ] **FJ55 year tells**
  A center-domed hood means a 1975-or-later 2F truck; lower rear lamps with integrated turn signals mean 1978 or later. Two-tone paint and grille-set headlights are original.
- [ ] **FJ45 body codes**
  IH8MUD's J45 chart lists codes by body: FJ45V/FJ45L wagons (1961–67), FJ45P-B long-bed pickups (8/64–1/75), FJ45RP and FJ45LP pickups from 1975, and FJ45V/LV Troopies from 6/77. HJ45 and HJ47 are diesel sixes; BJ45 is the four-cylinder diesel.
- [ ] **Bandeirante isn't a 55**
  Brazilian Toyota Bandeirantes (OJ50/OJ55, later BJ50/BJ55) are 40-series derivatives with Mercedes-Benz or Toyota 14B diesels. An 'OJ55' is a Brazilian pickup or wagon, not an FJ55.

NOTES

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